

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Seat of Awakening'

Bodhimaṇḍasya Yakṣālāṅgāra Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 508 · Derge Kangyur

བདུ་ཆག་སྒྲིབ་འོ་

Toh 508 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Bodhimaṇḍasya Yakṣālāṅgāra Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the dhāraṇī called "The Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Seat of Awakening." As its title suggests, the text belongs to the dhāraṇī literature of the Kangyur, a genre devoted to sacred ritual formulas believed to confer protection and spiritual benefit, and its content centers on a dhāraṇī associated with the seat or place of enlightenment. The text is set in the familiar sūtra frame of the Buddha teaching at Vārāṇasī in the presence of a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, lending it the authority of a direct discourse of the Blessed One. It was translated into Tibetan by the translator Tsang Devendrarakṣita and is preserved among the dhāraṇī collections of the Kangyur.

Translated by the Tibetan translator Tsang Devendrarakṣita, edited and finalized.

In the language of India: Bodhimaṇḍasya Yakṣālāṅgāra Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of China: Phu thi ṭa dra ī ṭāṇ yanra tho lo ni. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Seat of Awakening."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in the great pleasure grove of the great city of Vārāṇasī together with a great Saṅgha of five thousand monks, every one of them an arhat — with defilements exhausted, tasks accomplished, duties fulfilled, burdens set down, their own aims fully attained, and the bonds to continued existence entirely consumed — and together with an assembly of five hundred great bodhisattvas.

At that time the Blessed One, on a certain occasion during the waxing fortnight of the lunar month, taught the Dharma to the fourfold retinue and satisfied them with supreme joy. In that assembly there had gathered, beyond measure, countless tens of millions of sentient beings of every kind: those of the warrior class (kṣatriya), those of the brahmin class, speakers of the Vedas, naked ascetics, and many other logicians of various wondrous persuasions,

masters of the arts and sciences, those who haunt charnel grounds, tailors, those who undertake the ox-vow discipline, those who practice austerities in mountain ravines, and the entire host of Śaiva devotees. Among those gathered in that assembly, there were certain individuals who had been led astray by wrong views, had strayed from the path, and had fallen into the net of doubt. The Blessed One, with great compassion, taught them well and thoroughly according to precisely what they had asked, and dispelled every last one of their doubts.

Furthermore, gods (deva), nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, and hosts of humans and non-humans stood before him, gazed upon him, and surrounded him on all sides. Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), accompanied by his great retinue of divine sons of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, drew near to the Blessed One. Likewise, Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, came with a great retinue of divine sons of the Brahmā realm; and the divine son Sūrya, and the divine son Candra, and the divine son Subalavān, and the yakṣa Maṇibhadra, and Pūrṇabhadra together with all the other great yakṣa chieftains; and Īśvara, Viṣṇu, Yama, Varuṇa, Nirṛti, the Four Great Kings, the goddess Śrī, Sarasvatī, Harītī, Śaṅkhanī, Puṣpadantī, and the five hundred sons of Harītī — each accompanied by their own retinues; and the great nāga kings Sāgara, Nanda, Upananda, and others, each surrounded by their own vast retinues of nāgas numbering tens of millions upon tens of millions; and the kings of the kinnaras and of the great serpents, each surrounded by their own innumerable retinues — all of them came before the Blessed One, paid homage, made offerings, showed reverence and honor, and listened to the Dharma.

Now at that same time there lived in the city of Pāṭalī a great brahmin named Viṣṇudatta — wealthy, possessed of abundant and varied riches and resources, his enjoyments rivaling those of Kubera's own son, vastly learned, of great wisdom, with sharp faculties, broad discernment, delighting in virtuous qualities, firm in faith, and foremost among all male lay practitioners who had gone for refuge to the Three Jewels — and this man had no son.

Once it came to pass that this great brahmin had the following thought: "I have such great wealth and such a noble lineage — how can it be right that I have no son? This brahmin lineage, like a great tree, will be cut off — how can that be right? Even while I live, my purpose is diminished." And so, for many days and nights, he was tormented by suffering.

Then again at another time he thought thus: "The Buddha, the Blessed One, Teacher of gods and humans, is my father. I am a son of the Buddha. The true and sacred Dharma is my mother. The noble community of the Saṅgha is my brother and sister. Having obtained in this very life, through auspicious good fortune, such a wealth of felicitous blessing, I must make future lives meaningful as well. To that end, I should train in a single Dharma — one in which all the roots of virtue of the white teachings are gathered and which, with little difficulty, dedicates them to unsurpassed perfect awakening — so that the lineage stream of the Three Jewels may continue long and unbroken. As for the means by which, through the causes and conditions of virtuous action, sons and grandsons might cause the lineage to increase, why should I not ask the Blessed One about this? Now indeed I will ask him." So he resolved.

Then the great brahmin Viṣṇudatta came before the Blessed One, paid homage to him, circumambulated him three times, placed his joined palms together, and bowed. He then addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Teacher, Blessed One, please instruct me in a single Dharma through training in which all the roots of virtue of the white teachings are gathered, and by which, with little difficulty, unsurpassed perfect awakening is attained, the stream of the Three Jewels continues unbroken, and sons and grandsons cause the lineage to increase."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One replied to the brahmin Viṣṇudatta with these words: "Excellent! Excellent! Great brahmin, it is very good that you have asked me about this beneficial matter. Great brahmin, listen well, take it to heart — I shall explain it to you.

"Great brahmin, there is a dhāraṇī called the Great Royal dhāraṇī of Awakening, Garland of a Hundred Thousands, Ornament of the Awakening-Heart. This dhāraṇī gathers all the roots of virtue of the white teachings, generates them, brings them to complete fulfillment, and satisfies all hopes and wishes.

"As I now recall with mindfulness, in times gone by there was, outside the eastern gate of the city of Pāṭali, a great garden grove. That grove was called Āsuri. There resided in it a native-dwelling rākṣasī girl named Asura-sundari. This rākṣasī was evil by nature and greatly malevolent. She drained the color and vitality of the boys and girls who lived within a thousand leagues of her, and she stole away their very lives. And so most of the men and women who

lived in the city of Pāṭali were afflicted and tormented by the harm done by that rākṣasī; for a long time they lived in fear; they were imperiled by dread.

"Then one day, looking at one another, they deliberated over what means might free them from this suffering. At that time, among the gathered assembly of people, some elderly and knowledgeable persons spoke to those people thus: 'Friends, hear this! At this very time there dwells and abides in the world a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened Buddha named Supreme Light, Banner of the Sacred Rays. It would be right to go into his presence and ask him.'"

"That very Blessed One, that Buddha, will become your protector and refuge, and will dispel all your fears and sufferings."

When these words were spoken, those people asked in what direction and in what land the Tathāgata was dwelling. The elders answered that the Tathāgata was at that very time residing in the land of Lngalen. They asked again: "Good ones, please show us the means of meeting with that Tathāgata." The elders replied: "Return home. Seek out a place that is secluded and pure, and in that spot erect a square ritual ground with equal sides, prepared with a mixture of cow dung and clean earth. Anoint it with fragrant clay and the five products of the cow. Strew it with flowers of many kinds. Place four incense-burners with offerings of burnt incense, four vases filled with fragrant water, four vessels of food, and light four lamps. In the center, set out a reddish-gold vase filled with fragrant water, and beside it place a tooth-stick. Then, directing your minds with sincere faith toward the Tathāgata, make this supplication: 'Blessed One, out of your compassion for us, please deign to come to this very place at tomorrow's hour of the alms round.' The Tathāgata fully knows and perceives all the intentions, aspirations, and activities — however many and whatever their nature — of all sentient beings of past, present, and future. Even those who have fallen into birth in the hells, among hungry ghosts, or among animals he liberates through his skillful means, and he shows them the path to benefit and happiness. If you do this, the Tathāgata, knowing and perceiving with his superknowledge, will come to your dwelling along with his retinue through the power of his unobstructed miraculous ability."

When these words were spoken, those people took what they had heard to heart just as they had heard it, and returned home. Gathering together, they found a place that was secluded and pure, elevated and with open ground,

and arranged the ritual ground of clean earth mixed with cow dung. They strewn flowers of many kinds. They set out fine ornamental vases for the ritual ground, various pure foods and drinks, ointments, incense, and lamps. They also played various kinds of pleasant music. In the center they placed a reddish-gold vase adorned with various precious gems, filled with fragrant water, together with a tooth-stick. Then, all united in mind, united in aspiration, united in conduct, and uplifted by faith, in a melodious and harmonious voice, speaking in secret yet elevated tones, they made this supplication with one throat:

"We bow to, make offering to, and take refuge in the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened Buddha, Supreme Light, Banner of the Sacred Rays.

We bow to, make offering to, and take refuge in you, the Blessed One, the Buddha, the great Sage, whose very nature is compassion and protection toward all sentient beings.

We bow to, make offering to, and take refuge in you, the Blessed One, the Buddha, the great and mighty one, whose very nature is the inconceivable and wondrous nature of reality.

Out of your loving care for us — sentient beings who are without protector and without refuge, beings sunk in the mire of suffering — we beseech you to come to this place at tomorrow's hour of the alms round. Once you have come and are seated here, please accept the offerings we have carefully prepared, and please be the protector, refuge, and ally of us and of all sentient beings without exception. Please show us the path to benefit, happiness, and liberation. From all fears, all harms,"

"please dispel all our distress and weakness."

The moment this supplication was made, the earth quaked in six ways. The vase too shook and rolled along the ground. The water of the vase poured out onto the earth and became a great lotus pond. This pond was equal to divine water — fragrant, fresh, and sweet, neither too cold nor too warm, pleasing to the senses, and endowed with the eight qualities. It was full to the brim, with gold sand spread across the bottom. It was covered with a profusion of precious flowers: blue lotuses, pink lotuses, red lotuses, white lotuses, and many other kinds. In the center rose a great island with a ground of gold, and in the four directions there were stairways and four roads of various precious substances. In the middle stood a wishing tree of precious jewels, its canopy

spreading to a height of eight leagues, its branches trailing down to the water's edge. Its roots, trunk, branches, leaves, flowers, and fruits were all fashioned from the seven precious substances. This entirely pure, spacious, and level ground — each of its four sides twelve leagues across — formed a wondrous and extraordinary maṇḍala, beautiful and pleasing to the eyes of all beings. In the four directions and corners, garlands of trees adorned it: trees bearing flowers of water and land of many kinds — tamāla trees, campaka trees, apple trees, aśoka trees, atimuktaka plants, sumanā flowers, kadamba trees, nyagrodha trees, great nyagrodha trees, camphor trees, wild pomegranate trees with thorns, cypress trees, yūtikā plants, and tintuka trees, among others. In the branches of these trees sat various auspicious birds — parrots, peacocks, kalaviṅka birds, śaṅkha birds, and many others — with golden beaks and golden crests, their feathers and plumage all fashioned from the seven precious substances, singing out in many sweet and pleasing voices. All of this arose solely through the power of the former aspirations of the Tathāgata Dhvajāgrakeyūra — the Victor Whose Banner is the Ray of Excellence — and through the blessing of the dhāraṇī-mantra of the vidyā Hundred Ornaments of the Awakening Heart.

Then all the assembled people of the city of Pāṭaliputra were filled with the greatest wonder, and each turned to the others and spoke in this way: "How marvellous! Friends, such a great miracle as this — never before seen, never before heard — has appeared at this very moment! Whose power has brought about this great wonder? Who has displayed this mighty miracle? Could it be that in this Jambudvīpa there will soon arise an abundance of auspiciousness, benefit, and happiness?"

At that point, the elders among them addressed the assembled crowd and said: "Without any doubt, this great miracle is the power of the Tathāgata Dhvajāgrakeyūra. That Tathāgata has displayed this miracle as a sign of his coming to your dwelling place, for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. Let each of us now return to our own homes and, according to our individual means, prepare many excellent kinds of food and drink. Tomorrow we will offer it all at the noon hour to that Tathāgata, paying homage and reverence."

So all those people departed, joyfully and quickly, each to their own home. Through the night they prepared a great variety of fragrant and delicious foods and drinks, and also fragrant flowers, perfumed ointments, incense, powders, canopies, victory banners, streamers, and many kinds of musical

performances. Then they assembled by the roads and waited to receive the Tathāgata.

At that time, the Blessed One, the Victor of Holy Light-Rays, was dwelling in the land of Pāṭhari, teaching the Dharma to a great retinue, when suddenly a vessel adorned with the seven precious substances, together with its wooden stand, appeared before the Blessed One. The Blessed One, the Victor of Holy Light-Rays, looked upon the vessel with its wooden stand and smiled. Having smiled, he extended his golden hand bearing the mark of a wheel with a thousand spokes, took the vessel and its wooden stand into his hand, and sat in silence, saying nothing.

All those gathered in the retinue were filled with wonder, and said among themselves: "How marvellous! From what direction did this auspicious sign appear? To what land does it beckon, signalling the invitation of the Blessed One?"

Now in that retinue there was present a great bodhisattva named Pure and Excellent Intelligence. He rose from his seat, approached the Blessed One, bowed his head to the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated him three times to the right, and, pressing his palms together in reverence, addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, from what direction did this auspicious sign come? What is the reason for the vessel and its wooden stand? May the Blessed One please explain."

The Blessed One declared: "This vessel with its wooden stand has come from the great city of Pāṭhari. It has come in order to invite me to that very place. Pure and Excellent Intelligence, announce to the retinue the following: all those who wish to accompany me as I go for alms should take up their staffs. Tomorrow morning we shall go by miraculous power to the great city of Pāṭhari."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the great bodhisattva Pure and Excellent Intelligence took up a staff and announced it to the entire assembled retinue — to all the bodhisattvas and the host of śrāvakas — saying: "Let all those who possess great miraculous power and are capable of entering the sphere of miraculous action take up their staffs. Tomorrow morning the Blessed One will go for alms to the great city of Pāṭhari."

When the bodhisattva Pure and Excellent Intelligence had thus finished making the announcement, he returned to the Blessed One, urged him, and formally invited him.

Then, the following morning at dawn, the Tathāgata, the Victor of Holy Light-Rays, put on his three dharma robes properly, blazing with the finest ornament of splendour and majesty, and, accompanied by the great assembled retinue, by the power of great miraculous display he rose into the sky. Surrounded entirely by a vast host of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-faring eagles), kinnaras (half-human beings), and great serpents, who struck up various kinds of music and instrumental melody while making offerings of incense, flowers, perfumed ointments, powder-scatterings, garments, ornaments, and many other kinds of offering — in a single instant he traversed the path of the sky and arrived at the great city of Pāṭhari. There the Blessed One took his seat upon a lotus-heart lion throne at the centre of a great emanated maṇḍala. All members of the retinue likewise assembled and took their places, each within their own emanated lotus pavilion with its raised platform.

Then all the people of the great city of Pāṭhari, filled with great joy and delight, each offered their various carefully prepared offerings to the Blessed One and to the retinue of bodhisattvas and śrāvakas assembled with him, and —

— to all the assembled hosts of the eight classes of gods and nāgas. When midday arrived, they presented a lavish spread of various foods, excellent in colour, fragrance, and taste, satisfying everyone to their complete contentment.

The Blessed One and his retinue partook of the midday meal, then performed the washing and cleansing, and put their conduct in order. The retinue then circumambulated the Blessed One three times and took their seats in the proper order of ranks.

Thereupon all the people of the great city of Pāṭhari again paid homage to the Blessed One and circumambulated him, and then, arising from the cause of a matter of concern, they presented to him a prior circumstance in these words: "Blessed One, please hear us. Outside the eastern gate of this city there is a grove called Asurī. Within that grove there dwells a rākṣasī — a demoness — called Lhamin Dzema, of a wicked and vicious nature, fierce and savage. She continually steals the radiance and splendour of boys and girls, and takes their lives as well. Day and night, without respite, we live in terror and anguish, and have not the slightest opportunity for happiness or peace. We beseech the Blessed One, in his great loving compassion, to show us a means to remove this suffering. We beseech the Sugata to show us the way." So they made their

petition.

When they had made this petition, the Tathāgata Dharmaketu of Sacred Rays, with a mind of loving compassion for those assembled multitudes, accepted their request, remained silent, and smiled. As he smiled, rays of light in hundreds and thousands of colours streamed forth from his mouth and pervaded the entire great trichiliocosm — the world-system of the three thousandfold thousand worlds — bringing relief to all sentient beings. And in particular, that grove of Asurī was burned and utterly consumed by a mass of fire composed of miraculous rays of light.

The rākṣasī dwelling there, together with her retinue of many tens of thousands, scattered and fled in clusters in all four directions. Weeping loudly and crying out in lamentation, they wailed: "Alas! To whom shall we go for refuge? Who has the power to save us from this suffering?" And so they cried out and wept.

Then the gods dwelling in the intermediate sky spoke to them thus: "If you go before the Tathāgata Dharmaketu of Sacred Rays, pay him homage, and take refuge in him, you will be freed from this suffering and will attain happiness and peace of mind." So the gods declared.

Then Lhamin Dzema, together with her retinue of many tens of thousands, proceeded step by step to the emanated maṇḍala in the great city of Pāṭhari, and there she prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One Dharmaketu of Sacred Rays, touching her head to the ground. "Blessed One, we beseech you to protect us. Protector of the world, we beseech you to protect us. Sugata, we beseech you to protect us. From this day forward we shall do no harm to sentient beings. We shall not injure sentient beings." So they beseeched him.

Thereupon the Blessed One, by a silent intention, accepted their words, and entered into the meditative absorption called the Miraculous Blessing of the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Awakening-Heart. Arising from that absorption, he proclaimed the dhāraṇī of the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Awakening-Heart. At that moment, by the power of that meditative absorption and the might of the dhāraṇī mantra, all the world-systems of the ten directions and all the buddhas dwelling within them became vividly and directly apparent in manifest presence. And the teaching of the Dharma being given by each and every one of those buddhas to their own respective retinues was heard with perfect clarity.

All those Tathāgatas, rejoicing in the proclamation of the dhāraṇī of the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Awakening-Heart by the Blessed One, the Victor Whose Banner Is a Ray of Supreme Light, called out together from their own respective buddha-fields in a single voice and a single tone: "Excellent! Excellent! Tathāgata, Victor Whose Banner Is a Ray of Supreme Light, how excellent — how very excellent — that you have proclaimed the dhāraṇī of the King of Mantras, the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Awakening-Heart! Excellent! Well proclaimed!" So they declared.

Then the rākṣasī (Skt. rākṣasī) asura-goddess named Mdzesma, together with her retinue, was subdued and established on the path of the ten virtuous actions. And a countless multitude of beings was established on the stage of non-regression. The city itself was then transformed, becoming composed of the seven precious substances, and a rain of the seven precious substances fell down. All the beings of Jambudvīpa came to enjoy perfect happiness, free from suffering.

Great brahmin, at that time I was a brahmin boy seven years old. By hearing this dhāraṇī mantra, I gained pure faith in the teaching of that Tathāgata, and it is due to that I have now attained unsurpassed and perfect awakening. Great brahmin, have no doubt or uncertainty about this.

Great brahmin, it was you who at that time, in that age, came to be the asura-goddess called Mdzesma. Because at that time you did not take up a virtuous mind and instead caused harm to many sentient beings, you experienced incalculable suffering in the lower realms for countless aeons. But in the end, having gone for refuge to that Tathāgata and taken up the trainings, you are now born as a great brahmin, tall as a great śāla tree, endowed with vast wisdom and perfect prosperity — though on account of the residue of karma you have been born without children.

Great brahmin, the beings who then lived in the city of Pathāri are these very ones now present in my retinue — this great gathered assembly of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), asuras, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), kinnaras (Skt. kinnara), and so forth. Great brahmin, if you feel doubt or uncertainty about who exactly are the many tens of thousands of followers of Mdzesma the asura-goddess from that time and that age, great brahmin, put no such thought aside. And why? Because those many tens of thousands of followers of Mdzesma the asura-goddess from that time and that age are, in this present great assembly of my retinue, these brahmins, these warriors of

the kṣatriya (Skt. kṣatriya) class, these speakers of the Vedas (Skt. veda), these naked ascetics, these logicians and practitioners of other arts and sciences, these ascetics who dwell in charnel grounds, these weavers, these practitioners of the ox-conduct (Skt. govraṭa), and these ascetics who dwell in mountain caves.

Having thus explained those former karmic connections of theirs, Śākyamuni the Tathāgata remained in silence.

Then that great gathered assembly, having heard of such causes and conditions from former lives, was filled with profound wonder, and with joy and delight they took up incense, flowers, perfume, fine powder, garlands of flowers, garments, victory banners, pennants, and many other varieties of offerings, and offered them to the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times clockwise, and bowed their heads at his feet with palms pressed together in reverence. Then with one accord they made this supplication: "Blessed One, out of your compassion for us and for all sentient beings, please explain the dhāraṇī of the King of Mantras, the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Awakening-Heart. Blessed One, please explain it. Sugata, please explain it. This King of Mantra-Wisdom is the mirror and the lamp for all sentient beings.

In particular, when the final period of the five-hundred-year ages to come arrives, it will completely fulfil the wishes of all sentient beings.

When this supplication had been made, the Blessed One remained silent and smiled. As he smiled, rays of light of many varieties streamed forth from the Blessed One's mouth, illuminating all the world-systems in the ten directions, and all the buddhas dwelling within them appeared, vivid and manifest, fully before the assembly. Their teaching of the Dharma, too, was heard with perfect clarity. And the very ground was adorned on all sides by a vast grove of delightful celestial trees, their roots, trunks, branches, leaves, flowers, and fruits all fashioned from the seven precious substances. Every sentient being throughout Jambudvīpa came to enjoy divine bliss and happiness. These and other wondrous displays of miraculous sport, the splendour of blessing, appeared visibly in this world.

Then the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, beholding these signs, smiled with joy and came before the Blessed One. He prostrated, circumambulated three times clockwise, and with palms pressed together in reverence, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, so that

unceasing and abundant benefit and happiness may flow to all sentient beings, please explain the dhāraṇī of the King of Mantras, the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Awakening-Heart. Sugata, please explain it."

The Blessed One received the request in silence and then entered into the meditative absorption known as Closely Beholding All Buddhas. The instant he entered that absorption, by its power all the buddha-fields of every buddha in the ten directions appeared fully manifest without exception, and inconceivably many billions upon billions of buddhas drew as close as the distance of a single arrow-shot.

Thereupon all those Tathāgatas spoke with a single voice and a single melody: "Excellent! Excellent! Blessed One, Tathāgata Śākyamuni, it is supremely good that you have begun to speak this King of Mantras. Please teach it well. This King of Mantras was spoken and blessed by all the buddhas of the past. Now the time has come for you, Tathāgata Śākyamuni, to speak it. All of us rejoice."

Then the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, took up a single begging bowl, gathered into it the entirety of the dharmadhātu as proclaimed by the Blessed One, and offered it to the Blessed One. The Blessed One extended his golden-hued hand, received it, and tossed it into the sky before him. The bowl then transformed into the form of a Tathāgata that filled the entire expanse of space, and all the world-systems of the great trichiliocosm were filled completely. All of them then spoke with a single voice and a single melody, proclaiming "Excellent! Excellent!" to the Blessed One Śākyamuni. And before each of them appeared the Blessed One Śākyamuni together with his retinue, and before each Śākyamuni appeared the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī presenting a begging bowl.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, in these words:

"Mañjuśrī, for whose sake is this great and wondrous miraculous display — the gathering and full manifestation of all the Tathāgatas? What is its cause? What is its condition? Why has this transformation of radiating light been shown?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Vajrapāṇi, do you not know the causes and conditions of this display of luminous light and miraculous powers?"

Vajrapāṇi said: "Mañjuśrī, I do not know. A great miraculous display such as this — the gathering and full manifestation of all the Tathāgatas — I have never before seen or heard, and this is the very first time it has come to me

today."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, holding his vajra aloft, circumambulated the Blessed One three times and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Whatever Dharma you have now begun to teach, it reveals a miraculous display of wonders such as this — never before seen, never before experienced, never before heard."

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, wait a moment. In an instant it shall be made manifest." No sooner had he spoken than a stūpa built of the seven precious substances, seven thousand leagues in height and five thousand leagues in breadth, rose up from the earth. That stūpa was adorned with divine jeweled ornaments radiating light of every hue; streamers and pennants of divine silken cloth hung and fluttered from it; it was draped with a net of precious gems and pearls, with wondrous jeweled pendants, and from its golden bells and their clappers arose a variety of sweet and melodious sounds.

At that moment, tens of thousands of millions of divine sons descended from the sky, bearing in their hands every kind of offering implement, and they made offerings, prostrations, and circumambulations before that precious stūpa.

Then the Blessed One directed the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi to open the door of the stūpa. The moment he was so directed, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi — his body blazing intensely with masses of gnosis-fire, adorned with every kind of precious jeweled ornament, holding his vajra aloft, his countenance set in a fierce and furrowed expression, endowed with an awe-inspiring heroic bearing — went before that precious stūpa, stretched forth his right hand, and fully opened the door of the stūpa.

As it opened, within was revealed the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, known as Vast Golden Countenance Supreme in Heroic Radiance, Victory-Banner Pinnacle, seated and absorbed in meditative concentration, upon a lion throne fashioned from the gold of the Jambū River, supported by the seven precious substances, draped with coverings of various divine silken cloths.

Then that buddha, Vast Golden Countenance Supreme in Heroic Radiance, Victory-Banner Pinnacle, uttered these words of praise:

"Excellent! Excellent! Blessed One Śākyamuni! Tathāgata Śākyamuni, you have revealed such a great and wondrous miraculous display, causing the gathering and full manifestation of all the Tathāgatas. And yet in ultimate truth all phenomena have never in any way come together or gone apart — and yet within this world you have revealed such a wondrous miracle as this, something that did not occur even in the time of former buddhas. Now, Blessed One Śākyamuni, we beg you to teach the dhāraṇī called the Ornament of Hundreds of Thousands of Awakening-Essence Adornments, King of Perceptions."

"Blessed One, out of loving care for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, you have revealed the miraculous display in which the bodies of all the Tathāgatas appeared directly and manifestly — and this very cause and condition by which my stūpa arose upon the earth has also come about through the power and blessing of the dhāraṇī of the Ornament of Hundreds of Thousands of Awakening-Essence Adornments. Therefore the time has come, Blessed One, for you to teach the dhāraṇī of the Ornament of Hundreds of Thousands of Awakening-Essence Adornments."

When these words were spoken, the Blessed One Śākyamuni received and accepted the invitation of the Tathāgata Vipulavadana Kāñcanotkṣipta Prabhāsaketudhāraṇa — the Banner of Exceedingly Vast Golden Speech, Blazing with Six-Rayed Light — and then spoke this dhāraṇī, the King of Perceptions, the Ornament of Hundreds of Thousands of Awakening-Essence Adornments:

Oṃ namo bhagavate vipulavadan kāñcanotkṣipta prabhāsaketumūrdhane
tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya namo bhagavate śākyamunaye
tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya tadyathā bodhi bodhi bodhini
bodhini sarvatathāgatagocāre dhara dhara hara hara prahara prahara
mahābodhicittadhare culu culu ṣaḍraśmisahotdite sarvatathāgatābhṛṣikte
guṇe guṇavate sarvabuddhaguṇāvabhāse mili mili gaganatale pratiṣṭhite
sarvatathāgatādhiṣṭhite nabhistale śame śame praśame praśame
sarvapāpaprāśamaṇe sarvapāpaviśodhane hulu hulu
mahābodhimārgasaṃpratiṣṭhite sarvatathāgata supraṭiṣṭhite śuddhe svāhā.

This is the root mantra.

The moment the Blessed One had thus spoken this dhāraṇī, the Great King of Perceptions, the Ornament of Hundreds of Thousands of Awakening-Essence Adornments, all the buddhas dwelling in the ten directions praised it, saying:

"Excellent! Excellent! Well spoken!" All the emanation buddhas likewise praised it in unison: "Excellent! Excellent! Tathāgata Śākyamuni, you have spoken well — excellently spoken — this king of dhāraṇīs for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings." The very moment that unanimous praise was raised, this great earth trembled in six ways. The gods rained down a shower of varied flowers, and likewise offerings of perfumes and powders and incenses, garments and adornments of precious jewels of every kind, together with diadems, bracelets, necklaces, girdles, and the like were brought forward; offerings were made, and hymns of praise were sung in pleasing and melodious tones, and music of every variety was played. The shower of flowers was of this kind: utpala blossoms, red lotuses, blue lotuses and white lotuses, māṇḍārava flowers and great māṇḍārava flowers, rocana flowers, mañjūka and great mañjūka flowers, sumanā, vārṣika, campaka, saugandhika, and many other varieties of flowers rained down, and offerings and praises were made to the Blessed One.

Thus, when within the great assembled gathering the Blessed One spoke this king of dhāraṇīs, some attained the awakening of a pratyekabuddha; some attained the fruit of an arhat; some attained the fruit of non-returning; some attained the fruit of once-returning; some attained the fruit of stream-entry. Some generated the mind of awakening. Some came to abide on the ground of irreversibility. Some received a prophecy of unsurpassed awakening. Some sentient beings obtained the fruit of rebirth among the gods. Those sentient beings who had been born in the hells were liberated from all their suffering.

All those who had fallen into the realm of Yama, or had gone to the birthplace of hungry ghosts, or had gone to the birthplace of animals — all of them were liberated from the suffering of their respective births, obtained a human body, and entered the path of awakening.

In this way, wondrous miraculous events arose here in Jambudvīpa, and all sentient beings obtained an abundance of benefit and happiness. Then the bodhisattva and great being Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, joined his palms together, and spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this king of dhāraṇīs is exceedingly difficult to find. Whatever monk, nun, layman, laywoman, son of good family, or daughter of good family retains this dhāraṇī, recites it, masters it thoroughly, teaches it correctly to others, and takes it to heart properly — how great is the accumulation of merit for such a person?" The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent! Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, it is very good of you to ask

this. This question is supreme and sublime. Nevertheless, go now and ask Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, and he will explain it to you well." When this was said, Vajrapāṇi went to the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, circumambulated him to the right, and said to Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta the following: "Whatever person retains this dhāraṇī called the Hundred Thousand Adornments of the Essence of Awakening, recites it, masters it thoroughly, and extensively and correctly teaches it to others — how great is the accumulation of merit for such a person?"

Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta replied: "Vajrapāṇi, listen well. Consider, for example, all the world-systems of the great trichiliocosm — however many there are — and all the lands with their mountains, plains, passes, and hills large and small, ground down and pulverized to one part in a hundred, one part in a thousand, even down to the size of a hair. Even so, there would not be found a single place not pervaded by the finest particles. Likewise, when I looked with divine sight, I could not find any part of the Tathāgata's body that was not pervaded by relics — for I did not see any part of the Tathāgata's dharma body empty of dharmadhātu relics, bone relics, flesh relics, or mustard-seed-sized relics. Now, Vajrapāṇi, if someone possessed of supernormal knowledge and the power of miraculous ability were able to count that number, would you say, Vajrapāṇi, that such a person was endowed with wondrous intelligence and skillful understanding?" Vajrapāṇi said: "It is so." "Mañjuśrī: it is indeed so; such a person would be one endowed with wondrous intelligence and skillful understanding." Mañjuśrī then said: "Vajrapāṇi, listen. Those particles and those relics in such number and measure can be counted and calculated. But even if the Tathāgata were to remain for a kalpa, or more than a kalpa, or a thousand kalpas, and were to teach, the measure of the accumulation of merit that comes from the benefits of this dhāraṇī called the King of Dhāraṇīs, the Hundred Thousand Adornments of the Essence of Awakening, could not be fully expressed even through examples. Vajrapāṇi, this dhāraṇī called the King of Dhāraṇīs, the Hundred Thousand Adornments of the Essence of Awakening, is endowed with such a wealth of excellent qualities. Whoever retains this dhāraṇī, recites it, masters it thoroughly, teaches it extensively and correctly to others —"

— to say nothing of those who apply it with proper attention: even a person who merely writes it in a volume and renders it honor and respect will obtain an inexhaustible mass of merit — immeasurable, incalculable, beyond all reckoning.

Then, upon hearing those words of Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, humans, and non-humans assembled in that retinue were, without exception, established in the stage of non-return from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Some among them received a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Then all of them, with one voice, gave praise, exclaiming: "Ā la la! Well spoken!" And they bowed to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Śākyamuni, taking refuge in him. They bowed and took refuge in the buddha, the Blessed One, who wields lordship over wondrous and extraordinary miraculous powers. They then recited this solemn declaration: "We bow to and take refuge in the buddha, the Blessed One, whose deeds and enlightened activities are inconceivable."

Then Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, went before Mañjuśrī in his youthful form and said to him: "Mañjuśrī, how is it that, by relying on this dhāraṇī, the Hundred Thousand Adornments of Awakening, one produces and generates all roots of virtue?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Vajrapāṇi, it is proper to put this question to the Blessed One. The Blessed One knows this matter fully and without remainder."

Then Vajrapāṇi, Lord of Secrets, went before the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and addressed him thus: "Blessed One, how is it that, by relying on this dhāraṇī, the Hundred Thousand Adornments of Awakening, one produces and generates all roots of virtue?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, listen well and hold this in mind. I shall explain to you the method by which, through relying on this dhāraṇī, all roots of virtue are produced and generated. It is as follows.

A monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner, or any other son of good family or daughter of good family, having bathed their body and limbs and put on fresh, clean clothing, should prepare a square maṇḍala with earth purified by mixing in cow dung and fragrant substances, and thoroughly sprinkle it well with a mixture of the five products of the cow and fragrant water. They should spread flowers beautifully and arrange offerings. They should then bathe an image of the buddha with water consecrated by the blessing of this dhāraṇī. Likewise, they should anoint it with saffron mixed with powdered white sandalwood, also consecrated by the blessing of this dhāraṇī. Then, presenting whatever offerings they are able to

provide, circumambulating and prostrating, they should sit before the image, recite the dhāraṇī mantra once, and light a single butter lamp.

Vajrapāṇi, let me offer you a single analogy to illustrate the production and generation of roots of virtue. Listen. Suppose that all the great nāga kings dwelling throughout the great trichiliocosm were each to send down a great rain, with raindrops as fine as the finest dust particles. And suppose there existed a person endowed with great miraculous power who, by counting each and every one of those raindrops, was able to know their number and measure — even so, a Tathāgata, were he to remain for a kalpa, or more than a kalpa, or —

were to remain for a hundred thousand kalpas — even so, however much he might speak of the count of those raindrops, he could never finish. As for the measure of merit accruing from merely bathing an image of the kind described above, not even all the Tathāgatas together can know it.

Vajrapāṇi, let me now give you a brief account of how the interdependent connections of the accumulation of actions are established — actions that produce and generate roots of virtue and that fulfill the aims of one's aspirations. Listen.

Vajrapāṇi, should someone write this dhāraṇī, the Bodhyaṅgābhūma, on birch bark and place it inside a vajra ritual implement, or insert it inside a sacred image, or inscribe it on the interior of a reliquary, or place it inside the vase of a temple shrine, or deposit it within a stūpa — by constructing that single stūpa, the merit of having built a hundred thousand stūpas will be obtained. One will thereby obtain the merit of having erected that many stūpas.

Whether it be a monk, a nun, a layman, or a laywoman — or any other son or daughter of noble family — should someone write this dhāraṇī and place it inside a great stūpa erected at a crossroads, or on a high mountain pass, or on the bank of a great river, or at the gate of a city, or along a great highway, covering it with a rain-shelter or placing it beneath a parasol — that son or daughter of noble family will obtain, in the manner of the analogy I drew earlier, the merit of having built stūpas for all the relics of the dharmakāya (Skt. dharmakāya) equal in number to the atoms of the great trichiliocosm: relics of the dharmakāya, relics of the dharmadhātu, relics of bone, and relics of flesh — all of them.

A stūpa, it should be understood, is the maṇḍala abode of all buddhas. A stūpa is the tomb and reliquary of the nirmāṇakāya (emanation bodies) of all

buddhas. The Tathāgata, endowed with true and perfect speech, has declared it so.

Vajrapāṇi, furthermore, should any son or daughter of noble family make offerings at such stūpas — with flowers, incense, and whatever other offerings are available — or join their palms in reverence and bow down, or circumambulate even a single time, whether they be a monk, a nun, a layman, a laywoman, or any other son or daughter of noble family, the mass of merit produced and generated is immeasurable and beyond counting. All sins and obscurations will be entirely purified. Rebirth in the realms of hells, hungry ghosts, and animals will be cut off. One will become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Nor will one merely have made offering to a stūpa alone — one will have made offering with all those divine materials of worship to the Three Jewels: the Jewel of the Buddha, the Jewel of the Dharma, and the Jewel of the Saṅgha. One will attain the meditative absorption adorned with the signs and marks of irreversibility. Until one reaches the heart of awakening, one will obtain a perfectly pure body. The roots of virtue will never be wasted or lost. One will never again be born from a womb.

Vajrapāṇi, this dhāraṇī mantra is exceedingly difficult to obtain. Vajrapāṇi, should anyone cast it in bronze, inscribe it on copper, engrave it on wood or on stone of a precious kind, fashion it from aromatic medicinal clay, stamp it in unwrought copper, or cast it in a mixture of gold, silver, copper, and iron — three metals combined — or in iron alone, or

in silver alone, or in gold alone — or fashioned by any of these means into a stūpa or a sacred image, and then having this dhāraṇī mantra written on paper or on white silk and placed inside that stūpa or sacred image, and then prostrations, offerings, and reverential service are made to it — then, Vajrapāṇi, the measure of merit of that monk, nun, layman, laywoman, or any other son or daughter of noble family is beyond being reckoned by the rays of the Tathāgata, beyond being gauged by the Tathāgata's knowledge, beyond being seen even by the buddha-eye of the Tathāgata. It is equal in number to the relics previously taught, and equal in number to the drops of water in the great ocean — as many stūpas and sacred images as that. And that monk, nun, layman, laywoman, or son or daughter of noble family will not merely be counted as having prostrated to and made offerings before a single stūpa or sacred image enshrined with this dhāraṇī; rather, they will obtain the fruit of merit from having prostrated to and made offerings before all those stūpas

and sacred images.

Then the bodhisattva and lord of secrets, Vajrapāṇi, said this to the Blessed One: Blessed One, this great king of mantras is possessed of great splendor and majesty. It is possessed of great auspiciousness and benefit. It is possessed of great miraculous power and potency. Even one who merely holds the name of this dhāraṇī mantra generates immeasurable roots of virtue and obtains immeasurable merit.

The Blessed One declared: Vajrapāṇi, whatever monk, nun, layman, laywoman, or son or daughter of noble family, having aroused the wish to perfect and fully complete the great accumulation of merit and to prostrate to, make offerings to, and pay reverence to all buddhas of the past, the future, and those presently abiding — should that son or daughter of noble family write this king of mantras and place it in a casket, and each day offer it a bathing with fragrant water, make offerings to it, prostrate before it, and circumambulate it — then that monk, nun, layman, laywoman, or son or daughter of noble family will have rendered continuous and uninterrupted service, through the four modes of conduct, to all the buddhas of the past, future, and present, as gathered together by the similes previously taught. All the buddhas of the three times will bestow their blessing upon that son or daughter of noble family. All those Tathāgatas will give them prophetic assurance. All of them will breathe encouragement into them. That person will swiftly attain the stage of irreversibility from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, to the lord of secrets Vajrapāṇi, and to the four great kings: Today I entrust to you, my sons of the Victor, this dhāraṇī mantra, the king of mantras. Do not allow this king of mantras to be extinguished from the world in the last of the five hundred years of the future. Guard it well and keep it protected. Guard well, protect, and shelter those persons who hold this dhāraṇī mantra. Bestow your blessing upon those who practice with the mudrā exactly as it is and with the rite in its proper form. Fulfil their wishes. When this had been spoken, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, and

Vajrapāṇi, the lord of secrets, and the four great kings together with their retinues rose from their seats, bowed their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and addressed him in these words: "Blessed One, we have received your command correctly. We will guard, protect, and shelter that great person who

holds this great king of mantras, and we will make all his resources flourish in abundance. Even those who are without refuge and without shelter we will comfort and lead, and we will guard and protect them in every way until such time as one is seated at the seat of awakening and has turned the wheel of Dharma."

Then the Blessed One said "Excellent!" to the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, to Vajrapāṇi the lord of secrets, and to the four great kings, and spoke thus: "Excellent! Excellent! Do as you have pledged."

Then the Blessed One addressed the great assembled retinue in common, saying: This dhāraṇī mantra accomplishes all activities, bestows all siddhis, pacifies all wrongdoing and obscuration, and brings all aims to fulfilment without hindrance. If one bathes the body clean, dons fresh and pure clothing, and recites it one hundred and eight times each day, one will behold the faces of all the Tathāgatas. One will attain the span of a hundred years of life. All illness will be driven far away. All those abiding on the noble grounds will become one's protectors. Vajrapāṇi the lord of secrets and the four great kings together with their retinues will always guard, protect, and shelter such a one. Upon departing from this life, one will be born in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. Birth after birth one will arise by miraculous birth from a precious lotus, and birth from a womb will be utterly abandoned. In every birth one will remember former lives.

If one recites it twenty-one times, all the evil karma that is certain to bring one to hell will be completely purified. One will never fall into the lower realms. All enemies will come under one's power. If one recites it seven times, one will prevail in disputes.

On the fifteenth day of the bright fortnight, if one observes the fast for a full day and night without break, bathes, dons fresh and pure clothing, and sits cross-legged before an image, making offerings of flowers, incense, lamps, and the like, and recites this dhāraṇī of the Bodhicittābhūmi Ornament of a Hundred Thousand one thousand times — when the recitation is complete, one will behold the face of the Tathāgata Śākyamuni. The Tathāgata will extend a hand of golden hue, place it upon the crown of the practitioner's head, and breathe his blessing upon him, saying: "Excellent! Excellent! Great vidyādhāra, great being — the dhāraṇī of the Bodhicittābhūmi Ornament of a Hundred Thousand that you have practised is well accomplished. Great vidyādhāra, you are of great courage. Through mighty effort and austerity you

have attained immeasurable roots of virtue. Go now to whatever buddha-field you wish."

The moment this is spoken, a great mass of radiant light will blaze forth from the body of that vidyādhāra. Thereupon every siddhi spoken of throughout all the tantras of mantra, without exception, will be accomplished. All aspirations will be completely fulfilled. Even if that vidyādhāra has formerly committed any of the five actions of immediate retribution, all his wrongdoing and obscuration will be completely purified through observing the fast for a full day and night without break and performing the recitation.

All siddhis will be attained in this very lifetime.

On the fourteenth day of the waning fortnight of the month, one should wash the body well, put on fresh and clean clothing, and observe the fast for a full day and night without break. Then, before a stūpa that enshrines relics of the Teacher's body, one should fill a copper vessel with white mustard seeds. Having consecrated them by reciting this dhāraṇī mantra one thousand times, one should, at the time of performing the rite, pour a palmful of those mustard seeds into a pond where nāgas dwell. Those nāgas will be gladdened and will come under the power of the vidyādhāra. Invited to his presence in the nāga palace, they will bow at his feet and grant his every wish. Wherever he may reside, they will follow him day after day and carry out his commands.

If those mustard seeds are scattered in the four directions, heavy hailstorms and violent rain will be turned back. The mouths of all harmful creatures — horseflies, gnats, cuckoos, crows, and the like — will be bound shut. If the mustard seeds are cast into fire, the fire will not burn. If cast into a river, the flow of water will be cut off. If cast upon a merchant's goods and wealth, thieves will not be able to carry them away, and those goods will also become concealed and invisible. If scattered at the gate of a royal palace, the king, the queen, the ministers, and the entire retinue will be gladdened. If scattered among an assembly of men and women, all of them will make offerings and show respect to the practitioner. If scattered toward an enemy army, all foes will be bound and restrained. When setting out on a road, if they are scattered at a narrow pass or gateway, the guards there will not see the practitioner. If scattered over a field, the mouths of harmful creatures will be bound. In a time of drought, if poured into waters where nāgas dwell, plentiful rains will fall. When heavy hail or violent rain descends, if the seeds are scattered into the sky, it will immediately become calm. If scattered at an enemy's home, all

enmity will be fully pacified and henceforth they will become friends and companions. If scattered at the gate of a city, all sentient beings dwelling within who are afflicted by harm will be freed from that harm. Yakṣas and rākṣasas will be driven away to the far reaches.

When battle is joined, if the mustard seeds are scattered toward the side of the enemy, the foe will be defeated and one's own side will be victorious. During an examination or a dispute, if placed in the mouth, the speech will become powerful and one's side will prevail. If mixed into water and given to those who are sick to drink, their illness will be pacified. Those who are seized by spirits, if fumigated with mustard seeds mixed with salt, will be freed from all spirits.

For all epidemic diseases afflicting cattle and the like, or for all malicious diseases afflicting boys and girls, if mustard seeds are mixed with earth and burned at a crossroads, all plague and disease will be pacified.

If the mustard seeds are placed within a topknot, wherever one goes all people will be gladdened and pleased, will make offerings to the practitioner and show respect, and will listen to whatever the practitioner says.

Furthermore, starting on the night of the fourteenth day, if the vidyādhāra holds with both hands the feet of an image of the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī in his youthful form and recites the dhāraṇī without interruption through the dawn of the fifteenth day, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī will come before the practitioner and grant all wishes.

If one holds the feet of the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, recites this dhāraṇī one thousand one hundred and eight times, and offers incense prepared from guggul resin and clarified butter consecrated by the recitation, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi will make his body visibly appear before that practitioner, will grant all wishes, will accomplish all activities, will care for the practitioner as though for his own child, and will completely entrust to him the entire lineage of secret mantras.

If one holds the name of the yakṣa Suvarṇaprabhāsa and performs the recitation one thousand one hundred and eight times, he will make himself visibly appear together with a great heap of wealth and will bestow vast riches.

If one places it upon the head of a son of Vaiśravaṇa and fumigates it with the smoke of black agarwood while reciting one thousand and eight times, one will

find a thousand gold pieces. If one gazes upon the face of the goddess Śrī and recites one thousand and eight times, one will likewise find a thousand gold pieces.

Furthermore, if one paints an image of a yakṣa in five colors and recites one thousand and twenty times while offering incense of sarjarasa resin, a female yakṣa will appear before one and accept the commission to be sent forth, and will accomplish without remainder whatever tasks are assigned — whether a hundred kinds or a thousand.

Now the ritual procedure of the painted cloth will be explained. As for the method of accomplishing all activities by means of a painted cloth: one should paint on a piece of pure cloth that is unspoiled at the edges and has never been used, extending four cubits as far as possible, not derived from animal hide, washed clean with pure lye and well smoothed, by a craftsman who abides in the eight-limbed restoration observance and is endowed with cleanliness and purity.

In the center, one should paint Śākyamuni seated upon a lion throne beneath the awakening tree, adorned with various precious ornaments. Above him, one should paint the Tathāgata Uttamaprabhāsa with the banner of the supreme ray of light, displaying the mudrā of teaching the Dharma. To the right, one should paint the noble Mañjuśrī as a youth, adorned with all precious ornaments, kneeling on a lotus seat with both hands holding an alms bowl and presenting it to the Blessed One. To the left, one should paint the noble Vajrapāṇi, lord of secrets, adorned with all precious ornaments, with a wrathful yet smiling and majestic expression, holding the vajra in his hand in the manner of brandishing it, both knees on a lotus seat, gazing toward the Blessed One.

Behind the noble Mañjuśrī, one should paint a tall and spacious jeweled stūpa. Within it, one should paint the Tathāgata Suvarṇamukhottama, with glorious courageous rays of light forming a victory banner pinnacle, seated on a lion throne and depicted in the act of breathing out. Behind Vajrapāṇi, one should paint a jeweled casket inlaid with various precious stones, inside which the volume of the Bodhisattvahṛdayaratnākara scripture rests, with images of buddhas painted along its border and placed upon a lion throne. Below that, one should paint a vajra messenger with the form of a wrathful being. Below the stūpa, one should paint the goddess Śrī. Below Śākyamuni, one should paint the Four Great Kings wearing jeweled armor, with a glorious and majestic

appearance. Below them, one should paint the practitioner, holding an incense vessel in his left hand and a counting rosary in his right, gazing toward the face of the Blessed One.

Through the mere act of completing this painted image, all karmas that have brought one to fall into the three lower destinies — such as having abandoned the sacred Dharma, having disparaged noble ones, or having committed the five acts of immediate retribution — will be completely purified. One will become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Such being the benefit of the mere completion of the painted cloth, how much more need be said of the benefit of performing the practice before it — one will become equal in fortune to a Tathāgata.

Then the Blessed One explained this ritual of the maṇḍala of the Bodhisattvaḥṛdayaratnākara. Whoever wishes to establish this maṇḍala should choose a site in a temple, a divine hall, or a mountain valley — some place that is secluded, pure, and pleasant — and should take up the ground according to the ritual procedure taught in the tantras.

With earth consecrated by dhāraṇī mantras, mixed with ghee, one constructs a raised platform sixteen cubits in circumference. On this platform, one who is pure and clean draws a four-sided maṇḍala with four gates, each gate furnished with four stairways. In the center, one draws an image of the Tathāgata, and in the four corners one draws the four Great Kings. Inside each of the four gates one paints a jeweled wish-fulfilling tree, and before each of these trees one draws a goddess: at the eastern gate, the goddess Śrī; at the southern gate, Sarasvatī; at the western gate, Śaṅkhinī; at the northern gate, Puṣpadantā.

Having thus drawn the maṇḍala, one strews its surfaces with unhusked rice, white mustard seeds, and seasonal flowers. Fragrant unguents, powder incense, and stick incense are also arranged. At the four corners one places four vases filled with perfumed water. Four bowls of fine food and drink are also arrayed. At each of the four gates one sets a censer of burning incense. Bunches of various flowers are laid out, together with a torma of the three white substances. At the four corners one kindles four lamps. The vidyādhara practitioner faces east and performs the recitation. At the last session of the night, after performing the body protection and boundary-setting rites and so forth, one enters the maṇḍala. By the mere act of entering the maṇḍala, all sins and obscurations will be purified. One will become a fortunate being who

easily attains all accomplishments. One will come to possess an immeasurable accumulation of merit. All buddhas and bodhisattvas will always hold one in their regard. No elemental spirits will cause one harm. All the gods will protect, guard, and shelter one, and will assist one's practice with a thousand helpers. By the mere act of entering the maṇḍala, one will abide on the stage of non-return from which there is no falling back.

Oṃ sarva tathāgata vyāvalokite jaya jaya svāhā. This is the root dhāraṇī.

Oṃ huru huru jaya mukhe svāhā. This is the subsidiary dhāraṇī.

Oṃ jalenī jaye svāhā. This is the mantra of close contact.

Oṃ samanta pūrṇa jaye svāhā. This is the mantra for setting the boundary.

Oṃ maṇḍala jaye svāhā. This is the mantra for setting the boundary of the maṇḍala.

Oṃ śrī mīrī jaye svāhā. This is the torma mantra.

Oṃ sava sandhāri miri jaye svāhā. This is the mantra for invoking the assembly.

Oṃ buddha kusumaṃ svāhā. This is the mantra for offering flowers.

Oṃ jaya yanti svāhā. This is the mantra for offering incense.

Oṃ vijaya kapī svāhā. This is the mantra for conferring empowerment.

Oṃ tathāgata jaya svāhā. This is the mantra for binding the crown protrusion.

Oṃ jaya uriti svāhā. This is the mantra for consecrating the robe.

Oṃ guru dhari svāhā. This is the mantra for protecting and sustaining the disciple.

Oṃ dhara dhara miri jaye svāhā. This is the mantra for requesting the departure of the assembly.

Oṃ susambhava jaye svāhā. This is the mantra for consecrating the garland.

Oṃ sunari jaya yiye svāhā. This is the mantra for offering the seat.

Oṃ surī jaye svāhā. This is the mantra for binding the obstructors.

Oṃ pravara jaye siddhi svāhā. This is the mantra for invoking all the Tathāgatas.

Oṃ rakṣani jaye svāhā. This is the mantra for protecting the body.

Oṃ jaya dīpini svāhā. This is the mantra for offering lamps.

Oṃ male vimala jaye svāhā. This is the fire-offering mantra.

Oṃ sara sara jaye siddhi svāhā. This again is a mantra for invoking all the Tathāgatas.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words: "Now I shall explain the method of practice for the root dhāraṇī and the subsidiary dhāraṇī. If one recites the root dhāraṇī one hundred thousand times, one will attain the rank of a vidyādhara who turns the wheel of sovereign power."

If one places mustard oil in a copper vessel, consecrates it by reciting the heart-mantra one thousand times, and then applies a drop to the forehead, one will travel through the sky, and the doors of the dwellings of all eight classes of gods and spirits will open of their own accord, so that the practitioner may enter and move about at will. If one recites the mantra one hundred thousand times over antimony eye-medicine and then applies it to the eyes, one will attain the power of seeing the invisible, and will be able to enter freely into the dwellings of all spirits. Furthermore, if one recites it ten thousand times, one will behold the faces of all the Tathāgatas. If one recites the mantra one thousand one hundred and eight times over the parasol atop the finial of a stūpa's life-pillar and then raises it aloft, that place will become in its very nature a great stūpa in which all the relics of all the Tathāgatas are enshrined without exception. If one takes the alms-bowl, which is the hand-implement of Mañjuśrī, recites the mantra one thousand one hundred and eight times over it, fills it to the brim with rice gruel, and then places it in Mañjuśrī's hands and offers it as a parasol-measure, one thousand mendicants will be fully satisfied. Moreover, all the ritual activities taught in other tantras, when consecrated by this dhāraṇī-mantra, will accomplish every desired aim without effort.

Now the sequence of mudrās shall be explained. One joins the palms of both hands flat together, then, at the level of the heart, places the left palm flat within the right, and holds it there. This is the root mudrā of the dhāraṇī of the Bodhyaṅgābhisambodhi-dhāraṇī. By merely forming this mudrā, all negative actions will be purified, and all the Tathāgatas will bestow their relief and consolation. This mudrā invokes all the Tathāgatas, and all the Tathāgatas will take one under their care. From that same mudrā, by raising the right hand and reshaping it into whatever other mudrā is needed, all mudrās will arise, and all the Tathāgatas will bestow their blessing. From that same mudrā, by turning the right hand and placing it at the navel with the thumb and index

finger joined together, there arises the mudrā of all actions. All the Tathāgatas will bless one, and all karmic obscurations will be completely purified.

Then the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful, proclaimed this dhāraṇī-mantra for protecting and linking this dhāraṇī:

Namo Mañjuśrīyāye. Kumārabhūtāye. Tadyathā: Jaye. Vijaye. Jayaśrī. Jiṣṭhi. Hūṃ svāhā.

When a practitioner is about to enter into practice for the first time, and at each occasion of engaging in a ritual activity, if this mantra is recited seven times, all obscurations and obstacles will be dispelled and the aim will be quickly accomplished.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, proclaimed this dhāraṇī of the great vidyā: Tadyathā: Vajramuṣṭi. Hana daha paca vajra hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

If this mantra is applied to mustard seeds seven times and then scattered in the four directions, it will become the supreme means of sealing the boundary.

Then the Four Great Kings proclaimed this mantra:

Tadyathā: Dhṛti hrī mṛ sara prasara viri viri svāhā.

If this mantra is recited twenty-one times over water mixed with mustard seeds and the water is then poured over one's head, all harmful spirits will be brought under control, and they will bow their heads at the feet of the practitioner and return to their own abodes.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the Venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, I have taught this sūtra for the sake of beings such as these: those of meagre merit, those who have wronged their mothers and fathers, those who hold wrong views, those who are ridden with doubt, those who have committed the acts of immediate retribution, those with short lives, and those who are headed for the hells, the animal realm, the realm of the Lord of Death, or toward the acts of immediate retribution. It is for the sake of such sentient beings that I have expounded this dhāraṇī."

Ānanda, in a later time, in a future age, laypeople and monks who for the most part neither recite this dhāraṇī nor make offerings to it will suffer just as the laypeople described above were said to suffer. But if, in that same spirit of venerating the buddhas and relying upon this dhāraṇī, one constructs even a single stūpa, then all eighty-four thousand Dharma-adorned teachings will likewise be venerated. Beyond that, one will accumulate immeasurable heaps

of merit. One will come to recite and chant the Ornament of the Bodhisattva's Awakening Essence. And one will enter the maṇḍala of both the worldly and the transcendent.

When the Blessed One had thus proclaimed this sūtra, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, the great Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, the Four Great Kings, the brahmin Viṇudatta, the gods, the nāgas, and all the eight classes of beings — humans and non-humans alike — rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had declared.

The noble dhāraṇī entitled the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Bodhisattva's Awakening Essence is complete.

During the Tang dynasty, at the time of the Emperor Xuanzong, the abbot from the northern regions of India, a master of the three baskets (Tripiṭaka) named Vidyādhara Amogha Vajra, accepting the imperial commission, translated this from an Indian exemplar into Chinese. From that Chinese translation, at the time of the great Qing dynasty, a first-rank Taiji, a protector of the Mongolian lineage named Gonpo Kyab, prompted by the occasion of the compilation of a new abbreviated dhāraṇī collection under the direction of Deqin Wang, undertook this work and translated it into Tibetan at the Garden of Joy in his own residence. Because he was not proficient in Sanskrit phonology, he set aside the labor of analyzing the weight and rhythm of mantra syllables and so forth. Wherever earlier scholars had provided introductions to the wording of other sūtras, he preserved those as they were. As for the flowing prose section of Ānanda's words: since it does not appear in the Chinese but does exist in Tibetan, thinking it should not be cut, he drew it in from the Tibetan. Moreover, although the official translated canon reads "Dga' bo," certain manuscripts show "Kun dga' bo," and judging this to be more likely correct, he wrote it accordingly. The mantra of Vajrāyusā is not found in the Chinese source, and although it exists in the Tibetan exemplar — appearing after the essence and the near-essence — since its own provenance of transmission is not clear, he set it aside for now. This was completed on the first day of the fourth month of the eighth year of the Qianlong reign.

By this virtue, may all beings
Accumulate the twofold store of merit and wisdom,
And from that merit and wisdom
Attain the two sacred kāyas.

Below: the awakening...

Translator's Notes

- The list of divine beings in the assembly presents several interpretive choices. "Lusñan" rendered as Nirṛti follows a standard identification in Indo-Tibetan cosmological lists; some traditions gloss it as a demonic deity of the southwest direction. The figure translated as "Pāṭalī" for pa tha ri is the likely referent given the brahmin setting, though the Tibetan spelling is irregular and may represent a local variant. "Śaṅkhanī," "Puṣpadantī," and "Harītī" and her sons are standard figures in dhāraṇī literature; the Tibetan names map to these Sanskrit equivalents by convention in this genre rather than from explicit glossing in the text.
- The name of the rākṣasī, lha min mdzez ma, literally means "Asura Beauty" or "Non-god Beauty," and is rendered here as Asura-sundari to preserve both the meaning and the Indic flavor consistent with the proper-noun style of the text. The Tibetan lha min mdzez ma is a calque of a Sanskrit name that would be something like Asurasundarī.

The epithet of the past buddha, od zer dam pa'i rgyal mtshan, is rendered "Supreme Light, Banner of the Sacred Rays" following the literal sense; this is a name for a past buddha appearing in dhāraṇī literature and is not a standard canonical figure whose name has an established scholarly convention.

- The land name "Lngalen" is a transliteration of the Tibetan "ལྷག་ལའ་གྲོང་ཁུངས་," which does not correspond to a well-known Sanskrit toponym in available sources; it may be a regional or mythological place name peculiar to this text. The passage ends mid-sentence, continuing into the next section.
- The bird names kalaviṅka and śaṅkha are rendered from the Tibetan phonetic forms. The kalaviṅka is the mythical Himalayan bird renowned for its beautiful song; "śaṅkha" here renders "ལྷག་ལའ་གྲོང་ཁུངས་," which some traditions identify as a kind of auspicious bird. The tree name "ལྷག་ལའ་" rendered as "apple tree" is approximate; it may refer to a variety of fruit tree native to the Indian subcontinent rather than the common apple as such. "ལྷག་ལའ་" (tintuka) is a type of Indian tree and is left in transliteration as no common English equivalent is established. The city name "ལྷག་ལའ་" is Pāṭaliputra, the great Magadhan capital, and the context supports this identification. The phrase rendered "at the noon hour" (ལྷག་ལའ་གྲོང་ཁུངས་) literally means "at the time of the parasol" or "midday," referring to the traditional alms-round hour.
- The term rendered "wooden stand" for ལྷག་ལའ་ is the base or rack on which a ritual vessel is placed; some traditions gloss this as a wooden tray or tripod stand for the vase. The rendering "vessel with its wooden stand" captures the compound as a ritual object complete with its support.

The epithet ལྷག་ལའ་ (gandharva, literally "scent-eater") is given a brief gloss on first occurrence here since the preceding passage was not translated in this session.

- "Lhamin Dzema" renders the Tibetan name of the rākṣasī: lha min mdzas ma, meaning "Asura-born Beautiful One." Rather than silently substituting a Sanskrit reconstruction, the name is carried over in its Tibetan form since no Sanskrit equivalent is attested in context. The name could equally be rendered "Beautiful Asurī" or "Fair Demoness," but the narrative treats it as a proper name and it appears consistently as such.

"Dharmaketu of Sacred Rays" renders 'od zer dam pa'i rgyal mtshan, literally "Victory-Banner of the Sacred/Holy Rays of Light." This is kept as a flowing epithet-name for the Tathāgata addressed throughout this passage.

The phrase translated "Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Awakening-Heart" renders byang chub snying po'i rgyan 'bum, a compound title of the samādhi and dhāraṇī. "Awakening-Heart" here translates snying po in apposition with byang chub, indicating the essential heart or

nucleus of awakening, distinct from bodhicitta in its usual sense; the rendering preserves the doctrinal flavour without forcing the standard bodhicitta gloss.

- The name "Mdzesma" is a transliteration of the Tibetan proper name མཛེས་མཁའ་ or more precisely here མཛེས་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་, literally "the beautiful asura-goddess." It is retained here as a proper name since no standard Sanskrit equivalent is given in the text; a translator working from the Sanskrit parallel might find "Sundarī" or a similar rendering.

The phrase མཛེས་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་ (King of Mantras / King of Incantations) here rendered as "King of Mantras" could alternatively be rendered "King of Spells" or "sovereign mantra"; the doctrinal sense is that of a supreme or sovereign dhāraṇī formula.

The "ox-conduct" (མཛེས་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་) refers to non-Buddhist ascetics who imitate the behavior of oxen — a practice known from Pāli and Sanskrit sources as govraṭa.

- The phrase "the five-hundred-year ages to come" refers to the traditional periodisation of the decline of the Dharma after the Buddha's passing, in which each successive five-hundred-year epoch marks a further stage of degeneration; "the final period of the five-hundred-year ages" thus means the last degenerate age. This is a standard eschatological topos in Mahāyāna sūtra literature and the rendering follows that convention.

- The buddha-name "Vast Golden Countenance Supreme in Heroic Radiance, Victory-Banner Pinnacle" (Skt. form uncertain) is rendered literally from the Tibetan compound; it functions as an epithet-name throughout and is consistently rendered this way.

The phrase rendered "King of Perceptions" translates a Tibetan term meaning literally "king of conceptual cognitions / discernments"; in this dhāraṇī-sūtra context it carries a positive, exalted sense of sovereign comprehension rather than the more negative valence "conceptual thought" would suggest in Madhyamaka contexts.

- The Tathāgata name invoked at the opening of the dhāraṇī section — rendered here in phonetic Sanskrit from the Tibetan transliteration — is Vipulavadana Kāñcanotkṣipta Prabhāsaketu. The Tibetan reads "shin tu rgyas pa'i gser zhal mchog tu dpa' ba'i 'od zer rgyal mtshan gyi tog gis bskul ba," meaning roughly "invited by the crest-banner of the victory-standard of rays of supremely courageous golden speech, greatly vast." This appears to be the name of a distinct Tathāgata whose invitation prompts Śākyamuni to teach; the Sanskrit reconstruction follows the Tibetan transliteration of the dhāraṇī's opening homage rather than a verified canonical Sanskrit source, and some syllable clusters in the dhāraṇī itself are phonetically reproduced as found in the Tibetan rather than normalized.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end ("Whoever retains this dhāraṇī... teaches it extensively and correctly to others —"), indicating the supplied Tibetan text ends before the clause is completed. This is preserved faithfully in the translation by leaving the sentence open, as the continuation was not provided.

The term rendered "Lord of Secrets" for Vajrapāṇi reflects his standard epithet gsang bdag, "lord/master of secrets," which is a conventional title in tantric literature.

- The phrase "five products of the cow" renders a standard ritual formula; the five are milk, curds, butter, urine, and dung, well attested in Buddhist ritual literature. This is a genuine technical term and its enumeration may be useful for listeners unfamiliar with the convention.

The final sentence is deliberately left incomplete, as the Tibetan passage breaks off mid-construction, resuming a formulation already begun in the preceding passage. The translation mirrors this continuity exactly.

- The term rendered "Bodhyaṅgābhūma" is a reconstructed Sanskrit for "མཛེས་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་མཁའ་" — literally "the Hundred Thousand Ornaments of the Heart of Awakening." This is a proper title of the dhāraṇī text under discussion. The reconstruction is

tentative; the Tibetan title is used as a dhāraṇī name throughout, and no standard Sanskrit canonical equivalent has been firmly established.

The phrase "བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་" is rendered "written on birch bark," following the standard identification of འབྲུག་པོ་ (Skt. bhūrja) as birch bark, the classical Indian writing material.

The phrase "བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་" is rendered "vajra ritual implement," understanding འབྲུག་པོ་ as a hand-held ritual implement or emblem, and འབྲུག་པོ་ as specifying the vajra specifically.

- The phrase rendered "gathered together by the similes previously taught" translates "sngon bstan pa'i dpe bsdus pa," meaning that all those buddhas are encompassed or summed up by the analogies given earlier in the text, such as the number of relics and the drops of the great ocean. This is a compressed expression in the original; the rendering follows the most natural doctrinal reading.
- The term rendered "Bodhicittābhūmi Ornament of a Hundred Thousand" translates བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་, which is the title of the dhāraṇī text being described. The compound is somewhat unusual; "བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་" can mean "essence of awakening" or, as a place name, "the seat of awakening" (Bodh Gayā). In context the title appears to be a proper name for the dhāraṇī text itself, and it has been rendered as a proper title throughout.

The five actions of immediate retribution (བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་) are the five heinous acts: killing one's mother, killing one's father, killing an arhat, wounding a buddha, and causing a schism in the Saṅgha.

- The phrase rendered "bound shut" for the mouths of harmful creatures reflects the Tibetan idiom of "mouth-binding," a standard formulation in dhāraṇī literature for neutralizing dangerous animals and pests; it is a ritual silencing rather than a literal physical act.

The yakṣa name at the end, given in Tibetan as "nor bu bzang po," literally means "Good Jewel" or "Excellent Jewel." This appears to be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name such as Suvarṇaprabhāsa or a similar yakṣa name; the reconstruction offered here is approximate, and the identity of this specific yakṣa figure may warrant further textual investigation.

- The Tathāgata name rendered here as "Uttamaprabhāsa" (in context: the banner of the supreme ray of light) and "Suvarṇamukhottama" require comment. The Tibetan "བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་" and "བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་" are descriptive epithets for Tathāgatas that appear to be names rather than standard canonical figures with fixed Sanskrit equivalents. They are rendered descriptively in the English rather than forcing unattested Sanskrit reconstructions. The passage overall likely derives from a Mahāyāna sūtra in the Ratnakūṭa or dhāraṇī literature tradition.
- The four goddesses named in the maṇḍala — Śrī, Sarasvatī, Śaṅkhinī, and Puṣpadantā — represent standard directional goddess figures adapted into this Buddhist maṇḍala context; the Tibetan names are rendered by their closest Sanskrit equivalents. "Puṣpadantā" (literally "flower-toothed") is a less common epithet and the identification is made from the Tibetan བོད་ཀྱི་འབྲུག་པོ་ལྟ་བུ་.

The mantra strings are transliterated from Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit and contain numerous orthographic irregularities typical of Tibetan canonical transcription of dhāraṇī passages; no attempt has been made to correct or normalize these, as the transmitted form is itself canonical.

- The term rendered "antimony eye-medicine" translates the Tibetan transliteration so bir, corresponding to Sanskrit sauvirāñjana, a collyrium or eye-salve made from antimony ore, well attested in Indian medical and ritual texts.

The phrase rendered "the power of seeing the invisible" renders the Tibetan transliteration an ta na, which likely corresponds to Sanskrit antarhita or a related term, meaning that which is hidden or invisible; the exact Sanskrit is uncertain but the meaning is contextually clear.

The name of the dhāraṇī rendered as "Bodhyaṅgābhisambodhi-dhāraṇī" translates byang chub snying po'i rgyan 'bum, literally "hundred-thousand-ornaments of the heart of awakening"; this may be a short title for the dhāraṇī collection in question and the precise canonical Sanskrit title has not been verified here.

- The colophon is a Chinese-to-Tibetan retranslation notice, not a translation from Sanskrit, and the named translator is the Tang-dynasty Chinese monk Amoghavajra (Tib. Rig 'dzin Don yod rdo rje), whose commission to render the text from Indian sources into Chinese is noted, followed by a Qing-era Mongolian scholar's retranslation into Tibetan. The final line "Below: the awakening..." appears to be a fragment introducing a subsequent dedication verse or section that is cut off in the source text; it is rendered accordingly.

The phrase rendered "Ornament of the Bodhisattva's Awakening Essence" in the sūtra body refers to the title of the text itself and is consistent with the colophon title.

"Taiji" is a Qing-dynasty Mongolian noble rank; it has been left untranslated as a proper administrative title.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.